

For Start-Ups, the Cloud is the Way to Go!

Experts opine that cloud technology has the potential to bridge the gap between a small and a large enterprise. For start-ups and SMBs, cloud computing can make life far easier for IT admins, as well as improve the bottomline!



According to Gartner's analysis, cloud computing has the potential to change IT in a big way. Gartner analysts opine, "It may end up removing the last vestiges of the captive IT organisation that owns its enterprise, as surely as the enterprise owns IT." It's not just enterprises and SMEs that are leveraging cloud technology; start-ups are not far behind. India, a country at par with many of the majors with respect to entrepreneurship, is seeing a spike in this trend. Start-ups are taking that extra step of getting on to the cloud and making the most of this phenomenon.

Why do start-ups need the cloud?

The cost of IT infrastructure consumes a good share of the budget of any organisation. Start-ups that are already short of funds in the initial stages feel the heat of expensive IT infrastructure. So, if a solution can cater to almost all their IT needs at a lower cost and with fewer worries, they go for it. The cloud is the answer for them. Yet, despite the fact that the cloud is a must-adopt trend currently, companies are taking their time in giving away direct control of their IT infrastructure to someone else.

Explaining the need for cloud computing in a start-up set-up, Rajesh Shetty, vice president, Cisco India and SAARC, says, "Cloud computing is the most reliable and scalable platform for a start-up as well as for an SMB, because it can fit itself perfectly, as per their requirements. Start-ups or SMBs, unlike large organisations, do not have a big IT team; nor do they have all the required resources in terms of infrastructure or budgets. So, the cloud is a solution that they can resort to, as they would get a very scalable and reliable global infrastructure, which is easy to use and cost-effective from the ROI perspective."

With cloud computing, start-ups do not have to worry about creating their own IT infrastructure or employing manpower to manage it. They can simply get it done by the cloud service providers. Reiterating what Shetty said, Ajit Gadge, manager, Sales Engineering, and database solutions architect for India, South-East Asia, Australia and New Zealand, EnterpriseDB, said, "The cloud can deliver a reliable global infrastructure to a small organisation at an affordable price. Small organisations across India are looking forward to the cloud and I